UX Strategy Report

M6 Assignment

Amee Minter

6/22/23

TWC 444 User Experience

Table of Contents

Introduction 1
Strategy 2
Scope 3
Structure 5
Skeleton 7
Surface 8
Rationale 10
Conclusion 11
Reference 12

Introduction

I am a gig worker. One of many. How many? I found the following information on Forbes.com:

"The gig economy will thrive in 2023. According to a report from Mastercard, it will increase by 17% to about $455 billion (pg. 2), and according to Statista, about 50% of the workforce will be freelancing in the U.S. by 2027. There are over 70.4 million people freelancing currently, and that number is estimated to reach 79.6 million by 2025 and 90.1 million by 2028" (Tsekov, 2023).

With all those gig workers out there, you'd expect to find numerous apps to support their endeavors. As a six-year member of the gig economy, I've tried a few. Sherpashare is one that's still around but the names of the others I've tried escape me. I've been using Stride, a free app, for a few years now to track

my mileage, income, and expenses for Rideshare, but I find it lacking in customization and unable to track my other gig data. Perhaps it's because my other gigs are scattered among 6-12 different focus groups and usability testing firms. My current app doesn't consider these gigs even though I do, and the IRS does too as payouts are considered income. I have therefore decided to create an app called GigBee that will not only track typical gig work like rideshare, food delivery, rental host, consulting, home services, etc., but also focus groups, survey taking, usability testing, and mystery shopping. I'm going to design my app using Garrett's 5 Elements of UX as a blueprint. These elements are strategy, scope, structure, skeleton, and surface.

Strategy

I couldn't say how many focus groups I've done or how much I've made in total. Well, not easily I couldn't. I could look at bank statements and PayPal, but that wouldn't account for the gift cards. I know I've completed 112 tests and made $1290 with UserTesting.com over a four-year period, but without a way to export the data, I'd have to go through each payment and note the date to organize earnings by week, month, or year. My current app, Stride, is easy to use but has very limited customization and a lackluster dashboard. Other apps I've found on Google Play or via a Google search are geared towards driving gigs. Hurdlr has a robust feature set but is too complicated and invasive. It wanted constant full access to permissions on my phone and it kept reminding me of this. I want to open GigBee and be able to do three things quickly: get a snapshot of my gig metrics or gigtrics (new app, new word), track mileage, and add gigtrics.

GigBee will be the sweet spot between Stride and Hurdlr, quick to set up, simple to use, free, and customizable. The more complicated it is to add data to a tracking app, the less likely the user is to enter it. I want users to open GigBee as soon as they go online to drive for a gig, finish a usability test, or walk

out of a focus group. Perhaps even the least trusting of all gig workers, the manual mileage tracking rideshare drivers, would put down their pens and notebooks and try GigBee.

Scope

I'll be focusing on the GigBee dashboard and Add/Edit Gig work screen when discussing the scope, structure, skeleton, and surface elements. I may also refer to these elements or planes in the context of home building because it makes it easier for me to visualize the design. It will be assumed that the user has already set up a login profile and populated the app with data. If the strategy plane is the shareholder meeting to decide what kind of structure to build (a high-rise condo), the scope plane is where the decision is made to add a gym, elevators, underground parking, and balconies. The scope element of UX details the functional requirements of the design from a task-oriented point of view as well as the content requirements from an information-oriented point of view.

Functional Requirements for Dashboard

- The GigBee dashboard will display the date with the day's corresponding income, income goal, expenses, and hours worked. The date can be expanded to show week, month, and year and the default view can be customized.
- A button to add/edit gig work will be displayed.
- A button to track mileage will be displayed. When the user is done tracking, they will be prompted to select the gig for which the mileage was tracked.
- The screen will include a profile icon where the user can update personal details, change login info, and delete the account.
- The screen will include a settings icon where the user can add/edit a gig company, export data, set defaults for dashboard info, and set phone permissions.

- The screen will include a home icon that returns the user to the dashboard screen.

Functional Requirements for Add/Edit Gig Work Screen

- This screen will include a drop-down list of gig companies that the user has already set up.
- A save button will be displayed.
- The screen will include a profile icon where the user can update personal details, change login info, and delete the account.
- The screen will include a settings icon where the user can add/edit a gig company, export data, set defaults for dashboard info, and set phone permissions.
- The screen will include a home icon that returns the user to the dashboard screen.

Content Requirements for Dashboard

- This page will have a limited color palette of white (FFFFFF), orange (EF813A), dark purple (4F056D), and dark gray (5A5A5A).
- Call to action buttons will be a bright green and highlighted elements such as selected days or weeks will be highlighted with yellow.
- The profile icon will be 30 x 30 px with 3px weight white stroke.
- The settings icon will be 30 x 30 px, white.
- The GigBee logo is dark purple and 56 x 62 px.
- The top banner is 390 x 92 px and orange.
- The bottom banner is 390 x 60 px and orange.
- The main content area will be white.
- The GigBee name in the banner is Monserrat or similar.
- The text will be Sans Pro of similar and dark gray.

- The home icon will be white and around 35px or smaller.

Content Requirements for Add/Edit Gig Work Screen

- This page will have a limited color palette of white (FFFFFF), orange (EF813A), dark purple (4F056D), and dark gray (5A5A5A).
- The top banner and all of its elements will be present on every screen throughout the app.
- The profile icon will be 30 x 30 px with 3px weight white stroke.
- The settings icon will be 30 x 30 px, white.
- The GigBee logo is dark purple and 56 x 62 px.
- The top banner is 390 x 92 px and orange.
- The bottom banner is 390 x 60 px and orange.
- The bottom banner and all of its elements will be present in every screen throughout the app.
- The main content area will be white.
- The GigBee name in the banner is Monserrat or similar.
- The text will be Sans Pro of similar and dark gray.
- The home icon will be white and around 35px or smaller.
- The Save button will be around 120 x 60px and dark purple with a white font.

Structure

I feel like this is the construction phase where all the rough-ins are done.

Interaction Design for Dashboard

Once the user has an account set up the app will open to the dashboard screen. Here the user will see today's date, which is the default unless changed in settings. To the right of the date are the user's

income, expenses, hours, income goal, and goal progress. To change the range for this information the user can tap on today's date and a calendar will open. The user can then select another day, week, month, or year. Once the new range is selected the user can close the calendar and the user's income, expenses, hours, income goal, and goal progress will change to match the range selected. A button to track mileage is present. When tapping the button, the user will go to a screen that begins tracking time and distance. This will continue to track even if the app is closed until the user taps the Done button. There will also be a button to Add/Edit Gig Work. When the user taps this button the Add/Edit Gig Work Screen will load. The fields on this screen will have > symbols to denote they can be expended. These symbols will be present in the calendar that pops open to allow users to select the desired week, month, and year. Selected days and weeks will be highlighted in yellow. Call-to-action buttons will change to a lighter tone.

Interaction Design for Add/Edit Gig Work Screen

This screen will contain a drop-down list that will contain the names of the gig companies the user has added. Once the user taps on the company they want to track a field will appear for the user to enter their data. Fields that contain drop down lists will contain > symbols to denote further action. The first field will be today's date. Once tapped the date will expand into a calendar where the user can specify the day, week, month, or year. There will also be an income field, mileage field, expenses field, and notes field. Once the user has completed entering the data, they will tap on the Save button. Once tapped the Save button will gently flash to a lighter tone and then read Saved.

Information Architecture for Dashboard

I wanted to create a scroll-free app without too much depth. The content on the dashboard that displays the date or date range will be grouped together with the income data to which it corresponds. This can

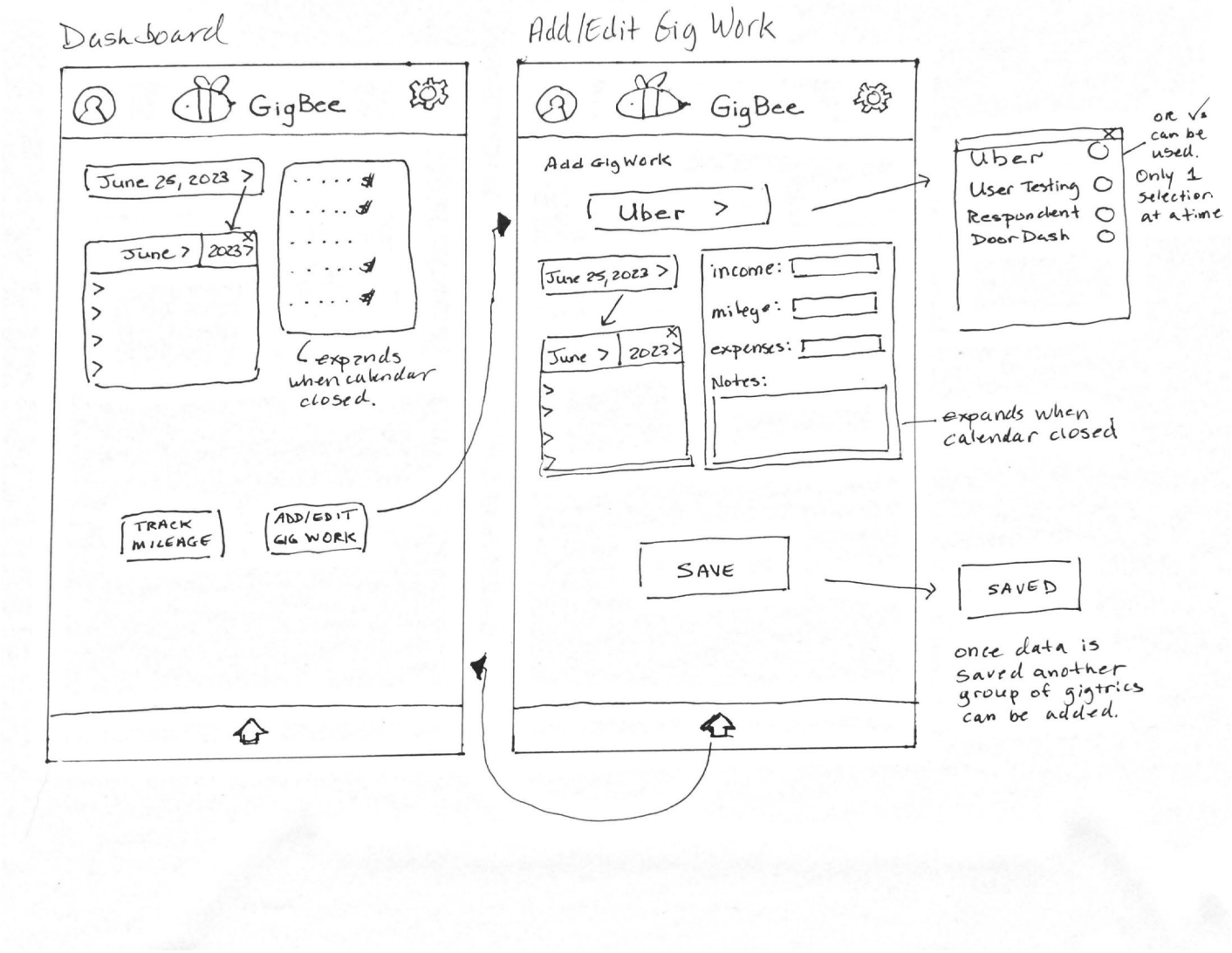
be achieved with white space or by grouping the content in similar tiles. The Add/Edit Gig Work button and Track mileage buttons will be grouped together, separate from the other dashboard content. The buttons will be obvious call-to-action buttons. The profile, settings, and home button will all be white and minimalistic to denote their less urgent purpose in the app. The purpose of the app is for users to easily see a snapshot of their gigtrics and add gigtrics therefore these features will be more prominent.

Information Architecture for Add/Edit Gig Work Screen

This screen has little content at first glance until the company name drops down and a gig is selected. Once the user closes the drop-down, the fields below the company name will appear. Alignment and grouping will separate these fields from the Save button. The Save button will have a different color and size from the gigtrics fields to denote its importance.

Skeleton

I think of the skeleton element as a period in new home construction when the buyers haven't picked out the paint, tile, flooring, cabinetry, or appliances. We know where everything is going to go, but we don't really know what it's going to look like until the interior designer gets involved. The low-fidelity dashboard and add/edit gig work are on the next page as I wanted to leave it large enough to be legible.



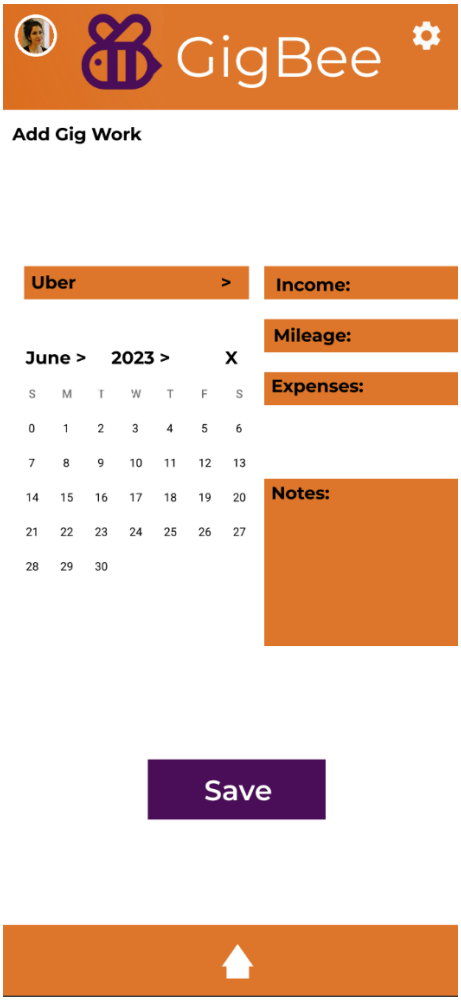
Expanded calendars can be closed once the user has finished defining the date or date range. Once a company has been selected in the Add/Edit screen, the list of gig companies can be closed. Only one company can be selected at a time. Once the data is saved in the Add/Edit screen the user can go back up to the company drop-down and add more gigtrics.

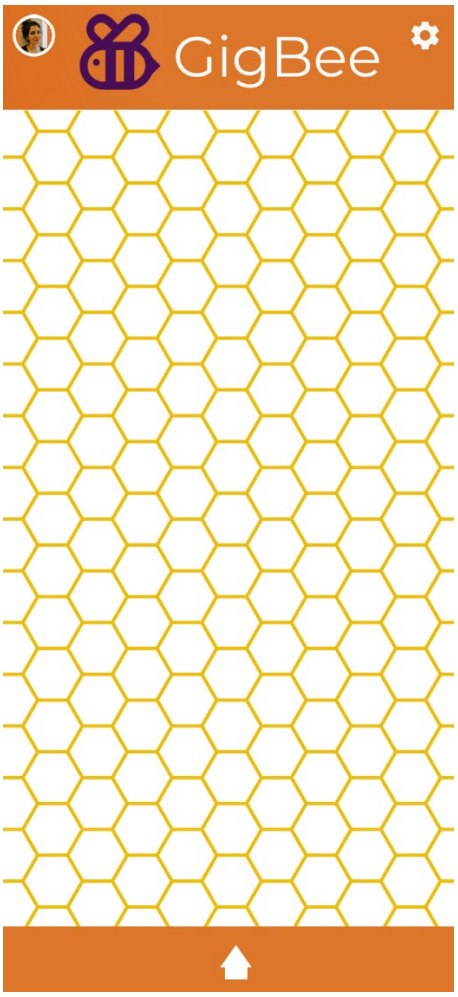
Surface

The surface plane is the hi-fi wireframe of your design. It’s the nice mockup from the interior designer.

Dashboard High-Fidelity Wireframe

Add/Edit Gig Word High-Fidelity Wireframe





Rationale

I chose these colors because so many of the other tracking apps are white and green, or white and blue. I wanted to try something different. The color scheme is meant to be eye-catching and memorable while maintaining a clean and professional look.

I wanted to design something uncluttered and efficient to use that reduces cognitive load by presenting a simple, intuitive interface. Recognizable icons and symbols, such as the greater-than symbol (>) to denote a drop-down or expansion help create a consistent experience. CTA buttons are easy to identify and with their distinct color and shape, stand out from the rest of the interface. This ensures that users can quickly locate and interact with the most important actions within the app.

Conclusion

Throughout the design process I've gained a deeper appreciation for the principles of UX design and the importance of creating intuitive and user-friendly interfaces.

While my design skills may not be at a professional level, I have learned valuable lessons about the iterative nature of design, the importance of user testing, and the need to balance aesthetics with functionality. Utilizing Garrett's 5 Elements of UX helped me to approach the design process in a structured manner, facilitating the creation of a cohesive and well-thought-out design.

I plan to continue honing my design skills and exploring techniques and tools for creating user experiences that delight users. I recognize that design is a continuous learning process, and I'm committed to staying up to date on design trends and best practices. My ultimate goal is to create more apps like GigBee and to work with users, designers, and developers to help create products that are both useful and highly usable.

Reference

Tsekov, P. (2023, March 21). *Council post: How to properly navigate the gig economy and the large pool of IT experts*. Forbes. https://www.forbes.com/sites/forbestechcouncil/2023/03/20/how-to-properly-navigate-the-gig-economy-and-the-large-pool-of-it-experts/?sh=599934266794